wounded him with his spear and unhorsed him and brought all the sheep back. No complaints were made on either side and so there the matter rested.

Now the poor lad is in trouble, and scamp as he is I am sorry for him. He and two or three more fellows of the same stamp, have been driving off cattle, buffaloes, from over the Koordish border. These he was too sharp to bring into the village, and I am much obliged to him for his consideration for had he brought them there and they had been traced they (the owners) would have come upon me to find them. He took them about twelve miles higher up, and hid them away amongst some plantations by the river side. The Koords, owners of the cattle, traced them by their hoof marks until near the town of Maranghd, when the tracks were obliterated by the great traffic. And altho these gentry are as clever at making out a track as Christie of Clinthill or any other borderer of the olden time, they were here at fault. By accident they met a boy from our village, who had been up the river to break down the dams and let the water down to irrigate our lands. He told them that he had seen amongst the trees four buffaloes, piquetted like cavalry horses with head and heel-ropes. The Koords went to the place and found their beasts. Khoda Kerreem Beg (the lieut.) who was near, made his escape and to use a Persian expression "he went and is still going" — that is nothing has been heard of him; for the Koords made their complaint to his colonel, and altho these things are thought much less of in this country than in many others, still such affairs can not be entirely looked over: and at times very severe punishments are inflicted such as cutting off ears, noses, hands, or feet, and even death.

The oldest inhabitants of the village say they never recollect such quiet times and what is better the people from the neighbouring villages say the same, and would be delighted to be taken under my government. The cotton cultivated near the shores of the lake has turned out very well, this is new ground and as the produce was uncertain I agreed to take half rent and taxes on it. It has depended upon rains for its moisture and has not been irrigated from wells as the other is. What induced the villagers to cultivate this ground was a water melon seed having dropped there by accident last year and the plant produced a fruit which weighed fifteen pounds. The villagers seeing this came to me and proposed to cultivate cotton if I would agree to take half rent and taxes, as if the season had been a very dry one, the crop might have failed and they would have lost their labour, and money laid out. This I agreed to do. But I do not think there is much chance of the crops failing for want of water, as they say that this is very near the surface, only about three feet I believe.

About half of the inhabitants of the village are tribes men or nomads belonging to the tribe of Mokuddum. These are bad cultivators but famous feeders

Generated on 2020-09-15 23:55 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112393
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN